

NATHAN SUNDAY

University of Michigan

105 S State St. Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Email: nsunday@umich.edu ◇ Website: <https://nathan-sunday.github.io/>

EDUCATION

University of Michigan

PhD. Candidate in Economics

2027 (Expected)

Master of Arts in Economics

2024

Makerere University

2019

Master of Arts in Economics

Makerere University

2014

Bachelor of Science with Education (Mathematics and Economics)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Finance/Economics (Primary)

Development Economics (Secondary)

DISSERTATION CHAPTERS

“Commercial Property Taxes, Firm Behavior, and Fiscal Externalities” [Job Market Paper]

- **Summary:** *This paper uses administrative tax data to study the economic costs of commercial property taxation, focusing on its effects on firm activity, including survival, revenues, profits, and employment, as well as tax incidence, distributional consequences, vertical fiscal externalities between local and central governments, and the associated welfare costs.*

“Old-Age Pension and Labor Market Outcomes of Younger Individuals: Evidence from Uganda”

- **Summary:** *This paper examines whether non-contributory old-age pension programs have spillover effects on labor market outcomes of ineligible adults in the household.*
- Awarded the prize for **Outstanding Third Year Paper**, 2024, Department of Economics, University of Michigan

“Decentralization, Firm Performance, and Fiscal Capacity: Evidence from Uganda”

- **Summary:** *This paper examines whether decentralization of governance generates tangible gains for the private sector and how it affects the fiscal capacity of the central government, using administrative tax data from Uganda.*

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Using Digital Connectivity to Expand Global Job Opportunities for African Workers”, (with Dean Yang, David McKenzie, Heesung Kim, Robertson Khataza, and Ted Lui). AEA RCT Registry. July 08, 2026. <https://doi.org/10.1257/rct.16818-2.0>

- **Summary:** *This projects examines whether reducing entry barriers into remote work, such as information and reputation frictions as well as liquidity constraints, improves remote-work outcomes for young African professionals.*

SELECTED PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

“Does Corruption Explain the Decision to Invest and the Value of Investment? Revisiting Evidence from Sub-Saharan African Firms” (with Ibrahim Mike Okumu and Edward Bbaale), *Journal of International Development*, October 2025.

“Gender of a Manager and Firm Performance in Africa: Does the Business Environment Play a Moderating Role?” (with Ibrahim Okumu and Edward Bbaale), *Journal of International Development*, Vol. 36, No. 8, November 2024, pp. 3082–3124.

“How Specific Resilience Pillars Mitigate the Impact of Drought on Food Security: Evidence from Uganda” (with Rehema Kahunde, Blessing Atwine, Adesoji Adelaja, and Justin George), *Food Security*, Vol. 15, No. 1, September 2022, pp. 111-131(2023)

SELECTED POLICY REPORTS AND ARTICLES

“A Rapid Assessment of the Effect of the COVID-19 Lockdown on Livelihoods and Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises in Uganda” (with Francis Mwesigye, Tony Odokonyero, and Mildred Barungi), *Economic Policy Research Centre*, Policy Note: 8, August 2021. [Link to the Report](#)

“Impact of COVID-19 on Micro, Small, and Medium Businesses in Uganda” (blog with Paul Lakuma), *Brookings, Focus in Africa*, May 2020. [Link to the Article](#)

“The **Uganda Business Climate Index (BCI)**, between 2019 and 2021 (Co-authored)”. Some of the BCI reports can be found at the following links: [\[BCI, March 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, Sept 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, Dec 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, May 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, June 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, Dec 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2021, Special Issue\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2021\]](#); [\[BCI, Aug 2021, Special Issue\]](#).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PhD Fellow , National Planning Authority, Uganda	May - Aug 2024
Research Analyst , Economic Policy Research Centre, Uganda	2019 - 2021
Labor Support Officer , Research Unit, Ministry of Gender, Labor & Social Development, Uganda	2018 - 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Instructor , University of Michigan	2022-2026
• Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 402)	Fall 2024, Winter 2025, Fall 2025
• Introductory Macroeconomics (Econ 102)	Fall 2022, Winter 2023, Fall 2023, Winter 2024, Winter 2026

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Graduate Research Award , Department of Economics, University of Michigan, \$3,000.	2025
Doctoral Research Grant , Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan, \$3,000.	2025
Outstanding Third Year Paper Award, 2024 , Department of Economics, University of Michigan Paper: Old-Age Pension and Labor Market Outcomes of Younger Individuals: Evidence from Uganda.	
Structural Transformation of Agriculture and Rural Spaces (STARS) Fellowship Program , Cornell University, International Food Policy Research Institute, and Michigan State University.	2020
Thematic Research Grant (US\$ 11,000) , African Economic Research Consortium.	2019 - 2020
Paper: “Gender of a manager and firm performance in Africa: Does the business environment play a moderating role”.	
Scholarship for Masters degree , African Economic Research Consortium (AERC).	2016 - 2018

Undergraduate scholarship, Government of Uganda.

2011 - 2014

HONORS AND PERSONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

Best student , Master of Arts in Economics, Makerere University	2019
Overall best student , AERC Collaborative Masters Programme (CMAP)	2017
Best student , College of Education and External Studies, Makerere University	2014

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2024: 6th World Bank/IFS/ODI Public Finance Conference, Washington DC

2019: African Economic Research Consortium (AERC) Bi-Annual Research Workshop, Nairobi, Kenya

SKILLS

Languages: English (Proficient)

Software: Stata (Advanced), R (Intermediate), LaTeX (Advanced), MatLab (Intermediate)

OTHERS

Citizenship: Citizen of Uganda (F-1 Visa)

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Dean Yang (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
deanyang@umich.edu

Joel Slemrod
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
jslemrod@umich.edu

James Hines (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
jrhines@umich.edu

Damian Vergara
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
damiv@umich.edu